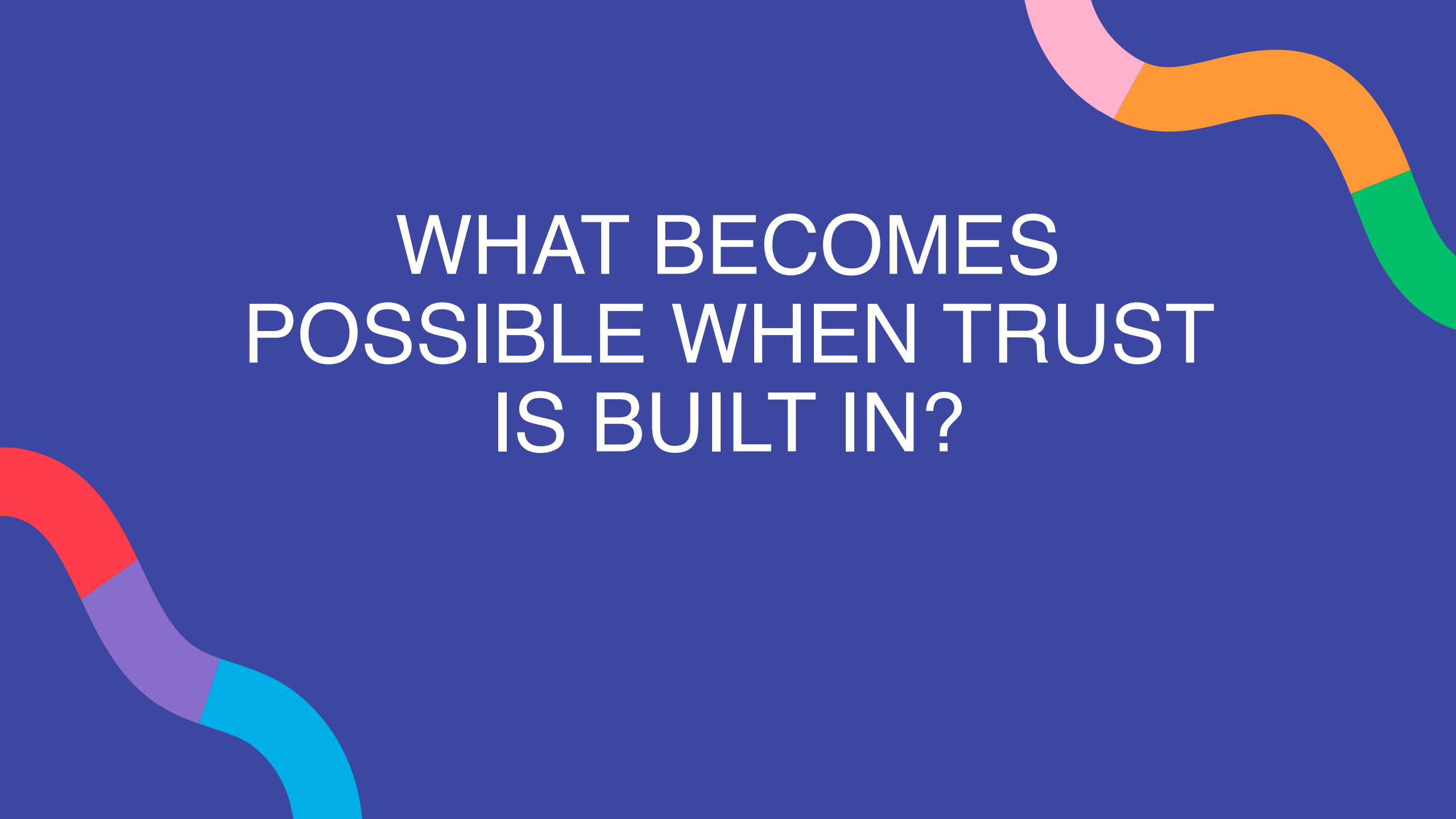




WHAT BECOMES
POSSIBLE WHEN TRUST
IS BUILT IN?



WHAT BECOMES POSSIBLE WHEN TRUST IS BUILT IN?

As organizations increasingly adopt cloud and AI technologies, they face a critical challenge: how to unlock innovation while maintaining control, ownership, and transparency over their data. Microsoft believes that data sovereignty means enabling organizations to control where their data is stored and processed, who can access it, and how it moves across jurisdictions. Data ownership, lineage, and cross-border flows should be explicit, transparent, and verifiable.

Microsoft's cloud, AI, security, and sovereignty capabilities enable organisations to build trusted AI solutions while maintaining transparency over where data is stored, processed, and accessed. Local datacenter infrastructure, sovereign cloud capabilities, and end-to-end governance tools help organisations meet regulatory requirements while unlocking the value of AI.



WHAT BECOMES POSSIBLE WHEN TRUST IS BUILT IN?

Your challenge:

Design and build an AI-powered assistant, agent, or solution that helps organisations create sovereign and secure AI environments.

Your solution should demonstrate how AI can simplify the journey from regulatory requirements to practical implementation by helping organisations:

- Understand and interpret data residency, privacy, and compliance requirements.
- Design secure and sovereign Azure environments based on business and regulatory needs.
- Apply governance, security, and responsible AI principles by default.
- Accelerate adoption of AI while keeping humans in control of critical decisions.

SCENARIOS

Three starting points. Pick one, or bring your own — the bar is the same: show where the data lives, prove one privacy technique, keep a human in the loop, and name the regulation you are designing for (GDPR, EU AI Act, NIS2, sector rules).



MANUFACTURING

Factory-floor copilot on plant data

An assistant for production engineers that answers from machine logs and maintenance records held on site.

Business continuity and low latency — Inference at the edge

Regulatory focus — GDPR for operator data; EU AI Act transparency duties for workplace AI

Show it live — A lineage panel: every answer traced to the log entry it came from



HR / TALENT

Screening with a human veto

AI ranks candidates and explains its reasoning, but no rejection is final without a person.

Sovereignty move — A bias-check summary rendered alongside every ranking

Regulatory focus — EU AI Act high-risk rules for employment; GDPR Art. 22 automated decisions

Show it live — The approval step — a human accepts or overrides the AI's call



RETAIL

Retail assistant that keeps customers' data home

A shopping and service assistant trained on purchase history, running in an EU-hosted environment.

Sovereignty move — Data residency you can point to on a diagram

Regulatory focus — GDPR consent and profiling; EU AI Act transparency for AI interactions

Show it live — An audit log a compliance officer could actually read

DELIVERABLES AND JUDGING CRITERIA

Deliverable

Prepare a 5-minute pitch covering:

1. The sovereignty challenge you are addressing.
2. Your proposed solution.
3. How the solution maintains control, transparency, and trust.
4. How AI creates value for users.
5. How your design aligns with principles of data sovereignty and responsible innovation.

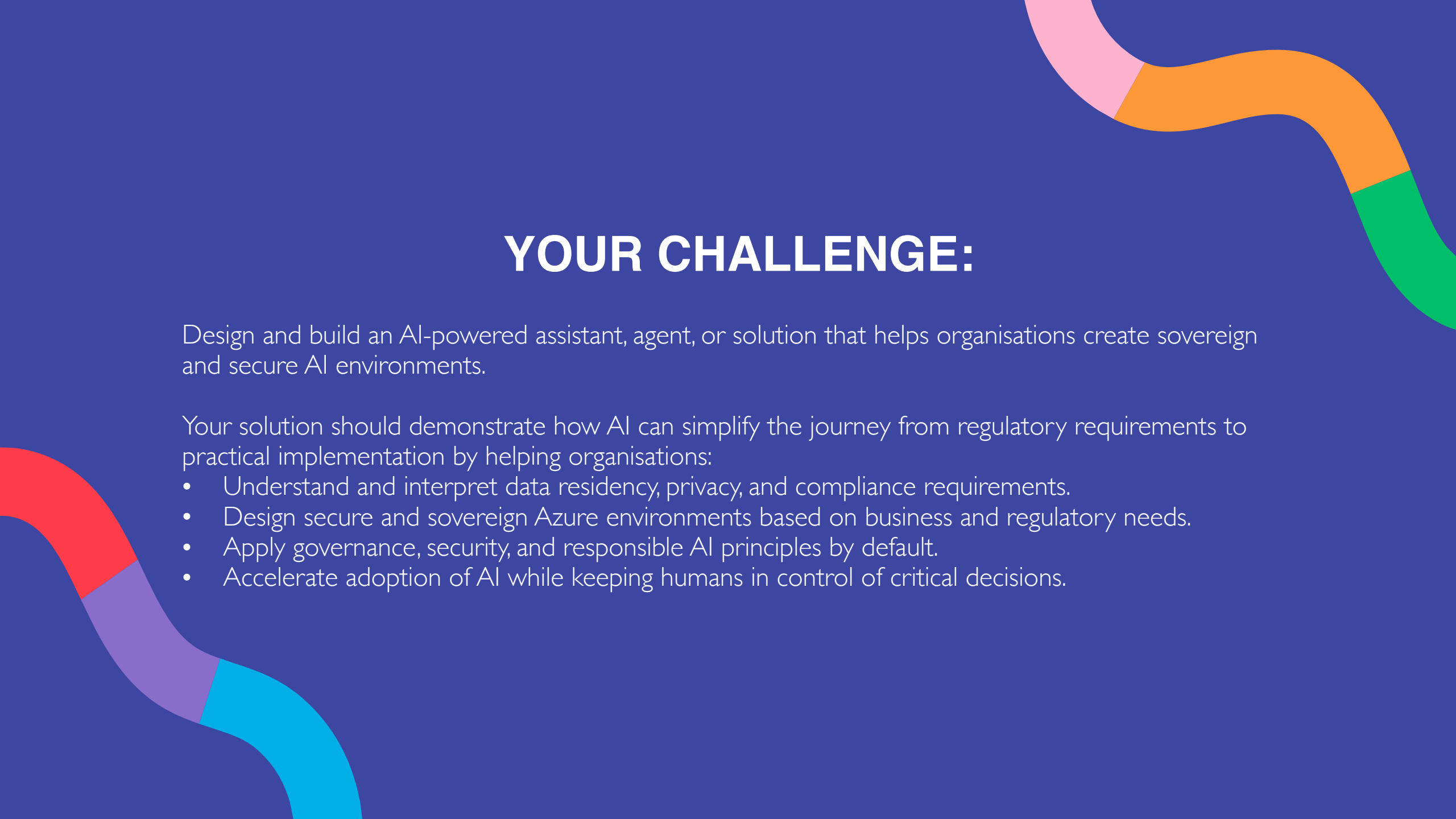
What we're judging:

Does it solve a real, believable problem for a real user?

Can you *show*, not just claim, that sensitive data stayed under control?

Did you address at least one concrete privacy/security technique and one human oversight moment?

Is the demo working end-to-end, even if small?



YOUR CHALLENGE:

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